



While toddy is not produced commercially yet, it is a matter of time before it gains scale

Six Brothers 1922 Resurrection is a limited edition of 102 bottles, each priced at ₹1.02 lakh



just in India but also on the global stage, but it needs acceleration on the part of all stakeholders to reach the status they deserve.” Achanta recently conducted a workshop on Indian native spirits at the Berlin Bar Convent, where he showcased leading Indian brands of feni and

mahua. “Whether it is the earthy taste of a Dukshiri feni or the silkiness of a mahua, they have very few parallels globally.”

While Goa’s cashew-based feni has been in the market for a long time with several established players, mahua’s commercial produc-

tion is relatively new with only a few brands such as DJ Mahua Liqueur from Desmondji.

Similarly, commercial production of other heritage liquors such as toddy and rice beer remains limited. However, Damodaran believes it’s only a matter of time. “While the more popular styles of spirits in India tend to be the ones with global acceptance—such as whisky, rum, gin, vodka, and tequila—I believe it is only a matter of time before at least one of India’s heritage offerings attains scale.”

Indian alco-bev entrepreneurs are also experimenting with other beverages. Himmaleh Spirits, a family-owned independent distillery based in Uttarakhand that introduced a gin sometime ago, has recently launched Bandarful, an artisanal cold-brew coffee liqueur, made from single estate Arabica coffee from Chikkamagaluru, Karnataka.

Co-founders Ansh Khanna and Samarth Prasad say that with coffee culture becoming a serious affair in the country, Bandarful stands out as an exquisite blend of high-quality coffee and spirit, making it an ideal choice for both coffee aficionados and alco-bev connoisseurs. With a 25% ABV, Bandarful not only complements cocktails but also serves well as a refreshing cold shot. Currently, it is available in eight states, including Uttarakhand, Delhi, Rajasthan, and Goa. They are looking at expanding globally to 20 countries within a few years, starting with the US.

Other craft spirits include Huli, a single-origin jaggery rum handmade at a micro distillery in Karnataka, and Eekh, a rum made from pure sugarcane juice, in Goa.

So the next time you head to a bar, try something old but new. **BT**

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